

Dolphin NetPlay Launcher

Friend Groups & .dnlgroupe Setup Guide

A quick, screenshot-based guide for setting up a Friend Group, sharing it with your group, and using it to host or join NetPlay sessions.

TL;DR

1. Go to **Options** → **Friends** and turn on **Enable Friend Groups**.
2. Create or edit a group: set the **group name**, **shared password**, **your session name**, **other members**, and **region**.
3. Click **Export active group...** to make a **.dnlgroupe** file, then send that file to the people in your group.
4. Each person imports the **.dnlgroupe** file and chooses **which member they are** on that PC.
5. To **join**, go to **Join** → **Friends**, pick the right group if needed, highlight a live Friend, **load/select** them, then use **Join**.
6. To **host**, go to **Host**, enable **Use friend group**, choose the group, pick a game, and Host normally.
7. Optional: add **badge images** and configure **Same-network / LAN** overrides for household/local players.

Important note

A **.dnlgroupe** file includes the group's shared NetPlay password and can include custom badge images. Share it **only with the intended group**.

1) Create a Friend Group

Friend Groups are for people who regularly NetPlay together. Instead of manually sending room codes every session, one person can create a group, export it, and everyone else can import the same setup.

A group stores the group name, shared password, your session name, the other members' session names, region, optional badges, and optional local Same-network / LAN overrides.

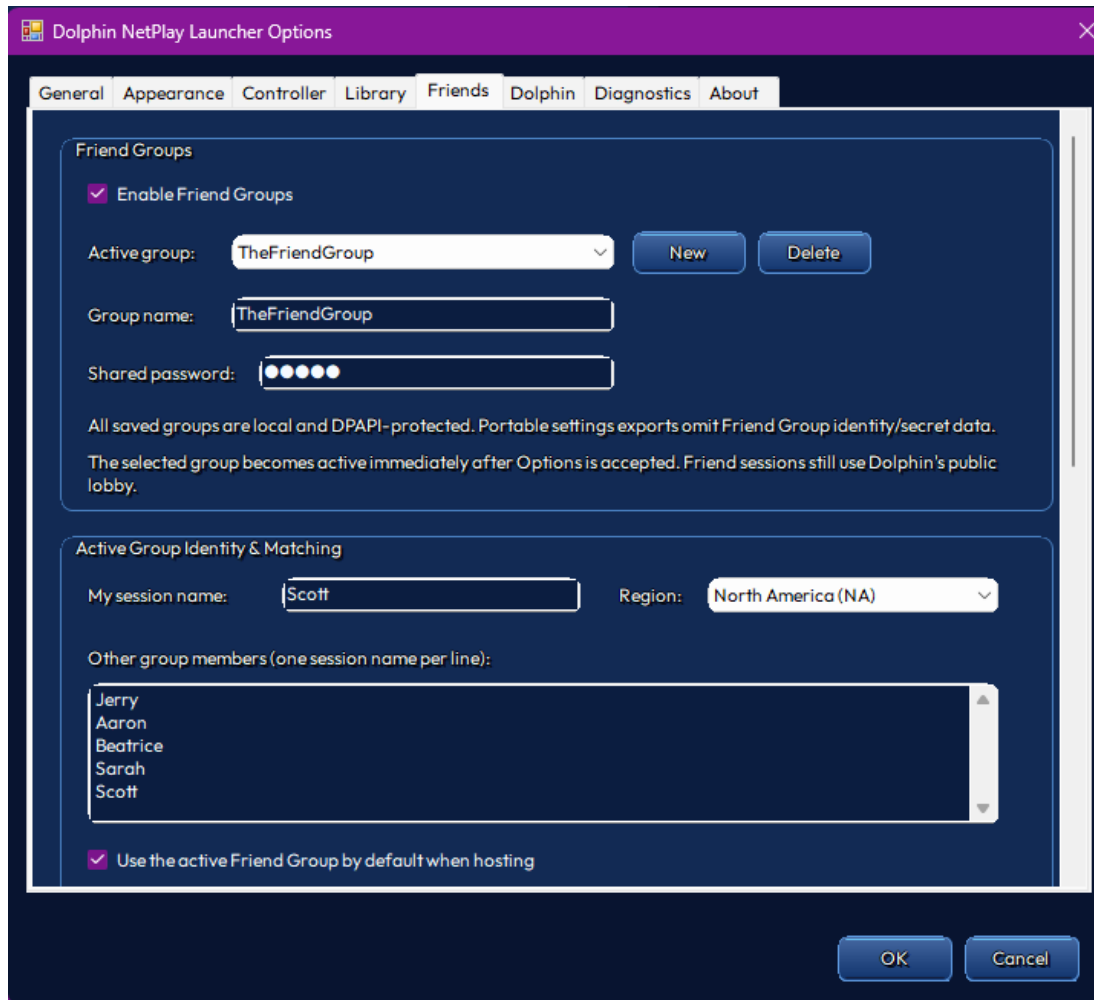


Figure 1. The top half of **Options** → **Friends**.

- 1 Open **Options** → **Friends**.
- 2 Turn on **Enable Friend Groups**.
- 3 Use **New** if you want another group.
- 4 Set a clear **Group name**.
- 5 Enter the shared **password**.
- 6 Set **My session name**.
- 7 Add the other members, one per line.
- 8 Choose the correct **Region**.
- 9 Press **OK** to save.

2) Share the group with a .dnlgroupe file

Once one person sets up the group, export it and send the file to everyone else in the group.

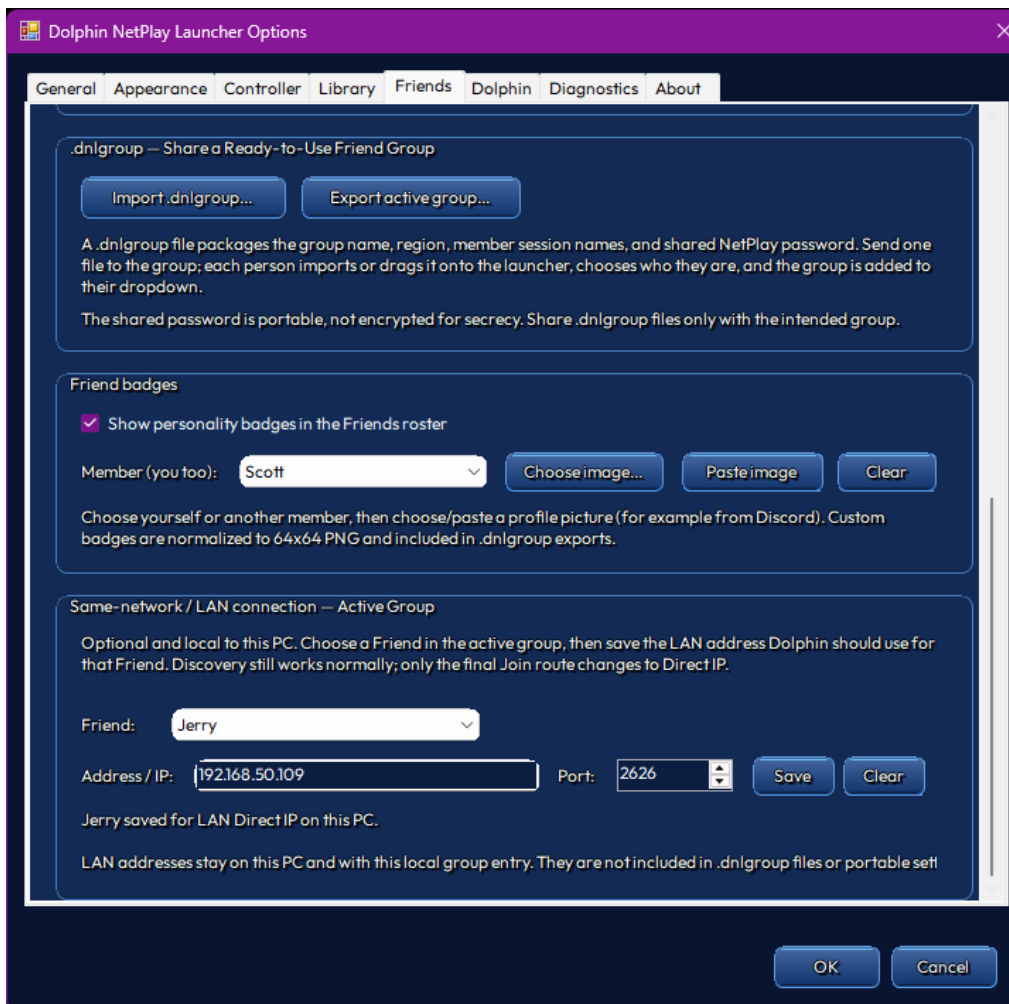


Figure 2. The lower half of Options → Friends.

- 1 Click **Export active group...** and save the **.dnlgroupe** file.
- 2 Send that file to the rest of your group.
- 3 On the other PC, use **Import .dnlgroupe...** or drag the file onto Dolphin NetPlay Launcher.
- 4 When prompted, choose **which member you are** on that PC.
- 5 The imported group becomes a saved local group, and everyone else becomes a Friend target.

Good to know

If you import the **same group name** again, the launcher updates the existing local entry instead of creating a duplicate.

Local Same-network / LAN settings stay on that PC and are **not** carried inside the **.dnlgroupe** file.

3) Join a Friend

When Friend Groups are configured, **Friends** becomes the default Join connection. The launcher checks Dolphin's public lobby for matching configured members.

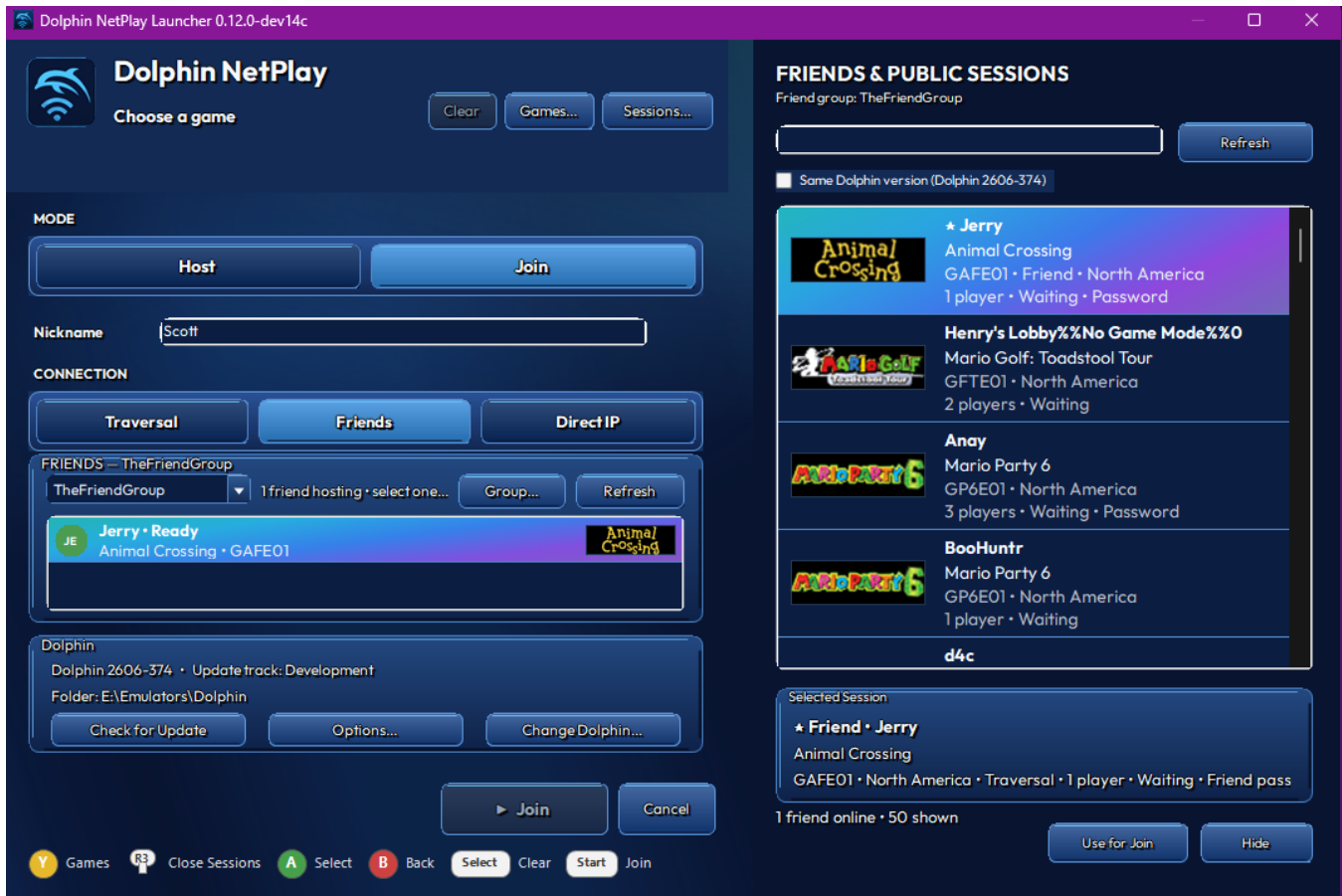


Figure 3. **Join** → **Friends** with an active group.

- 1 Choose **Join**.
- 2 Make sure **Friends** is selected.
- 3 Switch to the correct group if needed using the dropdown.
- 4 Highlight a Friend who is currently hosting.
- 5 Load/select that Friend.
- 6 Use the normal **Join** action.

Reminder

Your own identity is intentionally excluded from the Join roster.
Offline members are intentionally not shown as placeholder rows.

4) Host for a Friend Group

Hosting still uses Dolphin's public lobby. Friend Groups simply prefill the group's configured session name, password, and region into the normal Host workflow.

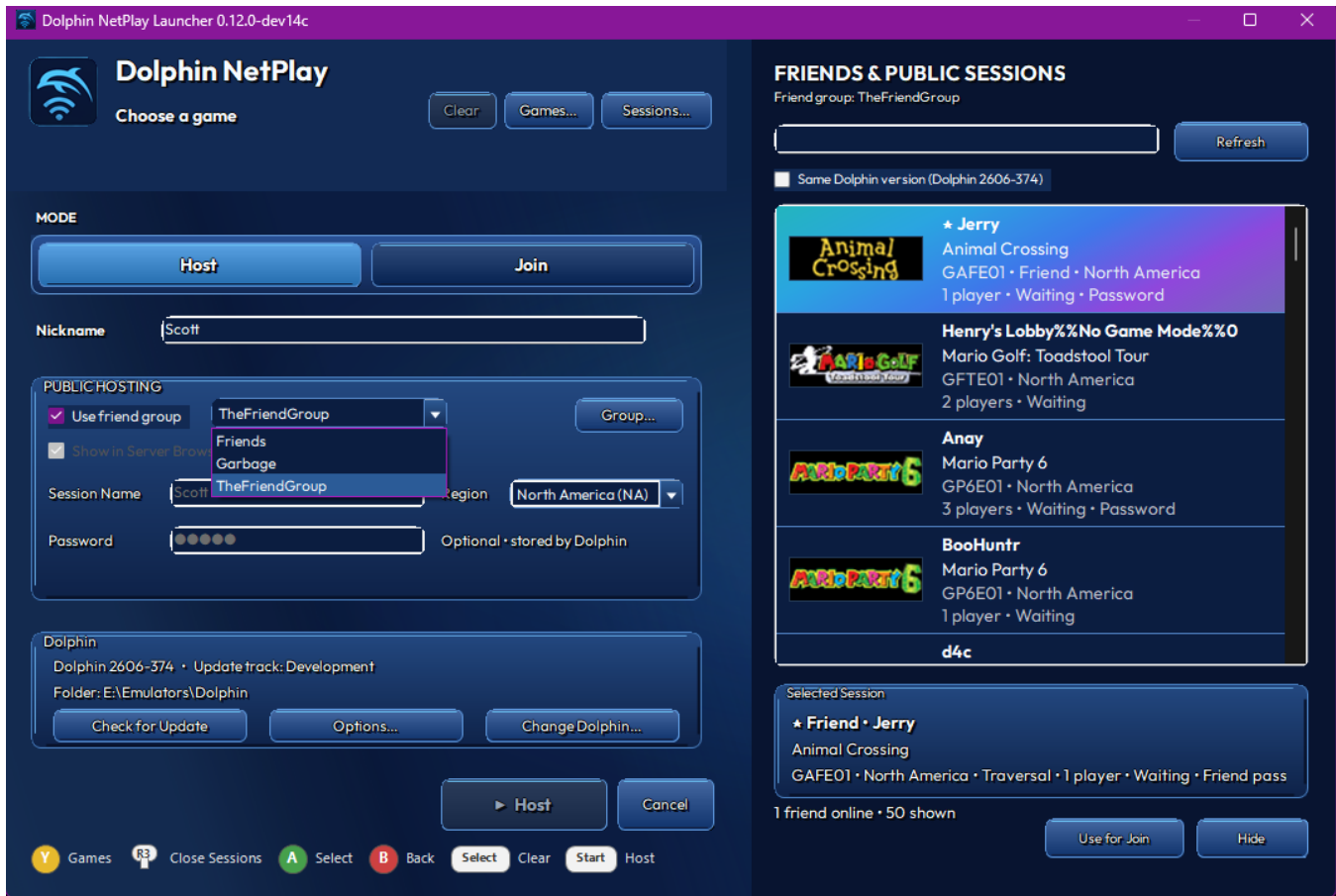


Figure 4. Host with Use friend group enabled.

- 1 Choose **Host**.
- 2 Turn on **Use friend group**.
- 3 Pick the group if the correct one is not already selected.
- 4 Choose your game.
- 5 Verify the session name, password, and region look correct.
- 6 Host normally.

5) Optional: badge images

Generated initials are the fallback, but you can set a custom badge image for yourself or any other member.

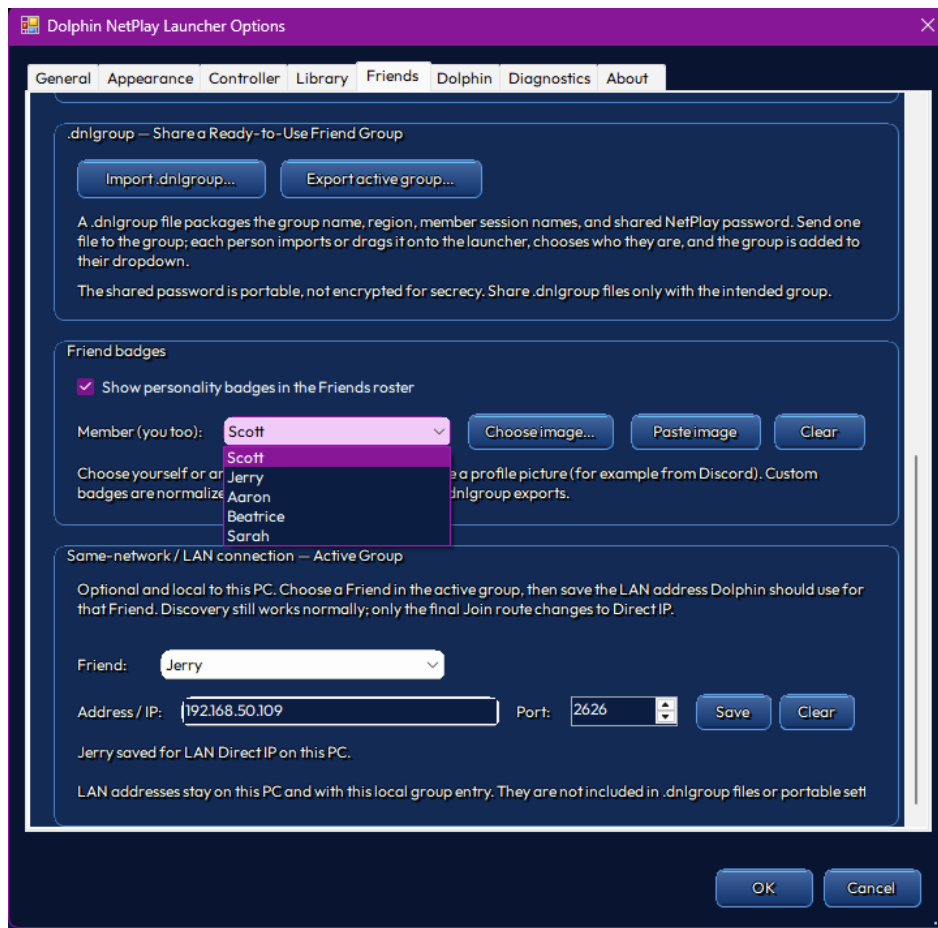


Figure 5. Choose a member, then use **Choose image...**, **Paste image**, or **Clear**.

- 1 Choose the member from the **Member (you too):** dropdown.
- 2 Use **Choose image...** to pick a file, or **Paste image** to use a copied picture.
- 3 Use **Clear** if you do not want a custom badge for that member.
- 4 Custom badges can be included in exported **.dnlgroup** files.

6) Optional: Same-network / LAN overrides

Only use this section if one specific Friend on the same network should be joined through a saved local Direct-IP route.

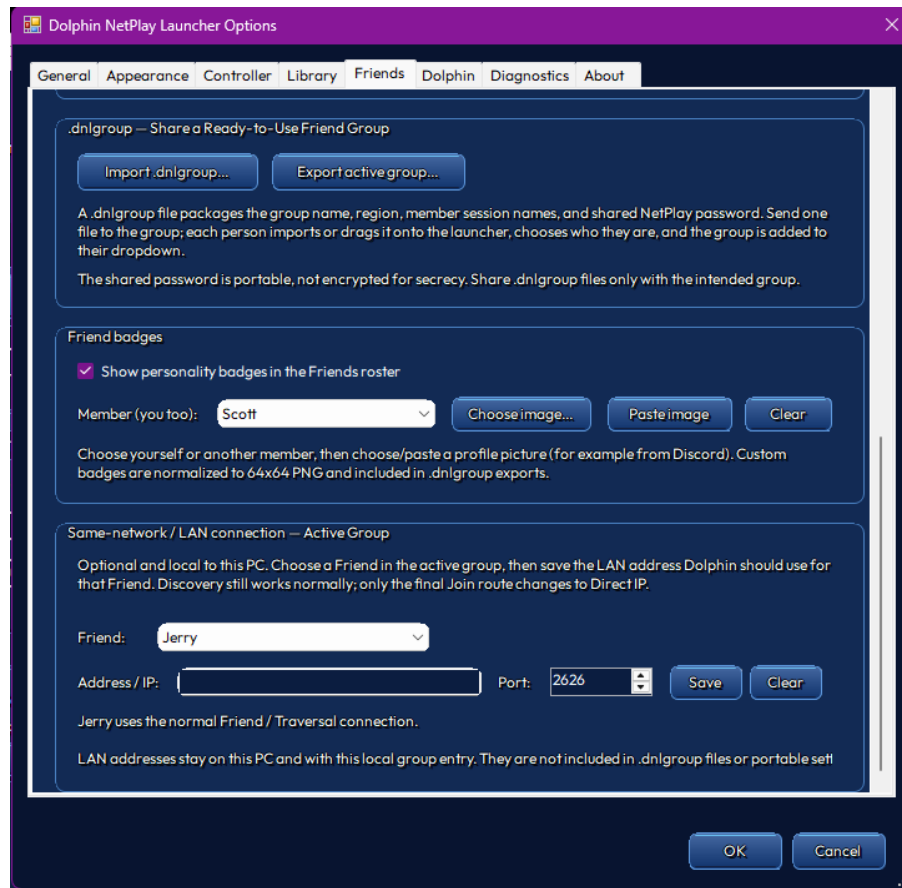


Figure 6. Same-network / LAN settings are optional and local to that PC.

- 1 Choose the Friend in the **Same-network / LAN connection** section.
- 2 Enter that host's local IP address and port.
- 3 Click **Save**.
- 4 When that Friend is loaded later, the launcher can default to the local LAN route on that PC.

Important LAN note

LAN overrides are **local only**. They stay on that PC and are **not** included in **.dnlgroup** files. If the Friend is temporarily hosting from another network, you can switch back to the Internet route for that Join.

7) Troubleshooting & tips

A known Friend is not appearing

Check that the correct group is active, the member/session names match exactly, the shared password matches on both sides, and press Refresh.

I see myself in the Join roster

Re-import the .dnlgroup and make sure that PC chooses the correct member identity when prompted.

A same-household Friend is found but joining fails

Use the Same-network / LAN section for that Friend on the joining PC. Do not put IP addresses into the member-name list.

Dragging a .dnlgroup file onto the launcher does nothing

If the launcher is running as Administrator and File Explorer is not, Windows may block drag/drop. Use Import .dnlgroup... instead.

Scope

Friend Groups are a convenience layer around Dolphin NetPlay.
Dolphin still handles emulation, NetPlay networking, and the public lobby.
Dolphin NetPlay Launcher does **not** provide game files, Dolphin builds, or a separate cloud account system.

Guide version: v1 • Based on the Dolphin NetPlay Launcher 0.12 Friend Groups workflow